Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Monkstone House

Monkstone House Residential Home, 1 Locks Common Road, Porthcawl, CF36 3HU

01656 782701

monkstonehouse.co.uk

The inspection visit took place on 21/10/2025

Service Information:

Operated by:	J & P RESIDENTIAL HOMES LIMITED
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care
Registered places:	41
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Monkstone House is a residential home situated in Porthcawl and provides care and support for up to 41 people.

People experience good well-being outcomes; they are supported to maintain their health and well-being and are treated with dignity and respect. There are effective systems to help keep people safe in an environment that meets their needs. The care and support delivered to people is good, because care staff have enough information to provide people with the right care at the right time and are knowledgeable about their routines and preferences. There are systems in place for safeguarding, medication management, and infection control. The physical environment is good, being safe and designed to support the needs of people who live there. Staff enjoy working for the people they support and feel positive about the team. The leadership and management at the service is good. A new manager is in post since the previous inspection. The Responsible Individual (RI) is a visible and involved presence in the service and is striving to make ongoing improvements.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People are treated with dignity and respect. They are supported to identify their well-being outcomes and encouraged to use and build on their strengths. There is a homely atmosphere that gives people a sense of belonging. During our visit, we spoke with people who told us they are satisfied with the support they receive at Monkstone House and are supported with making day to day decisions. One person commented "*I really can't find fault*". We also observed people being supported in a warm and genuine way and people told us the care staff are kind and caring. We saw a singer visits the home weekly, along with other external entertainers. Feedback from people, relatives and staff stated that more activities are needed. The provider has recognised this and is working to make improvements.

People are supported to maintain their physical and emotional well-being. The positive culture amongst the staff team ensures people's needs are met because care staff know what is important to them. Support from health and social care colleagues is sought quickly when needed. People are supported to maintain and sustain existing relationships with family and friends as much as possible. We saw friendships formed with people enjoying time in the lounges. Personal plans are tailored to each person and reflect their choices and how to maintain their safety. The service offers a variety of meals, and the service has a food hygiene rating of five, which is 'very good'. We saw people had a positive experience during lunch and their dignity was respected by the approach adopted by staff.

People are safeguarded from abuse and neglect. The building is secure, and visitors sign into and out of the home. This ensures there is an accurate record of who is in the building at any one time. Risks to individuals are included in personal plans and risk assessments, which are regularly reviewed. Equipment such as a call bell system, and sensor mats are available. They enable people to get the care they need at the right time if responded to appropriately. Care records and personal information are stored securely. Any issues or complaints can be raised with the manager, who has an open-door policy, or via the formal complaints process in place.

People live in accommodation that supports their well-being. Bedrooms are comfortable and personalised, with sufficient communal areas available. The home is clean and well-maintained, with the correct checks and servicing in place for utilities and equipment. There is ongoing refurbishment. Throughout our inspection, there was a lovely relaxed, friendly atmosphere which was created by the care staff team and their positive interactions with people and visitors to the service.

Care & Support — Good

People receive a good standard of care at Monkstone House. We saw people are supported in a kind and patient manner, with care being calm and respectful. People and their families were complimentary about the service, telling us "*I have confidence in the staff here*", "*I am treated respectfully*", "*It's nice living here"* and "*We couldn't have wanted better for him*". The service carries out an assessment prior to a person moving to the home to ensure they can meet their needs appropriately. Personal plans are person centred, reflect individual needs and give the information needed to support people well. Risk assessments are in place to ensure people are supported to make their own choices as much as possible and remain safe. Appropriate referrals are made to external health professionals, with the service acting on recommendations and direction given.

Medication is stored, managed, and administered safely. Medicines are stored securely in medication trolleys and administered in line with the prescribers' instructions. Medication administration record (MAR) charts contain all required information and are completed correctly with signatures when medication has been administered. Controlled drugs are also appropriately stored and recorded. We saw evidence staff receive training on the administration of medication to ensure they remain sufficiently skilled. The completion of routine medication audits ensures practice remains safe and effective. Records show regular contact with health and social care professionals when needed. We spoke with a visiting health professional who told us they have no concerns regarding the care and support provided at Monkstone House.

The service takes effective steps to protect people from harm. Care staff understand what safeguarding means, can recognise potential concerns, and know how to report them. They feel confident if they report issues to the management, they would be responded to appropriately. Incidents or accidents are recorded. Detailed risk assessments help support safe practices while allowing people to take positive risks. People and their families tell us they or their loved ones are safe at Monkstone House.

Infection control is well-managed, with appropriate measures in place to reduce risks. Staff have access to and use personal protective equipment. An infection control policy guides staff on how to manage outbreaks and protect people. The domestic team follow thorough cleaning routines, and laundry processes are designed to minimise infection risks. Clinical waste is disposed of safely and correctly.

Environment — Good

The environment is homely, clean and comfortable and suited to people's needs. There are communal areas which are well used. We saw people relaxing, eating and engaging with others. People were at ease with each other and staff and were relaxed and happy. Comments from people include, *"It's very clean here"* and *"It's spotless".* We saw people who are able choosing where to spend their time, seeing them going from their rooms to communal areas as they wish. People's rooms are a sufficient size and are personalised to their preference with items important to them, which helps create a homely feel.

The service demonstrates a commitment to ensuring the premises and any equipment is maintained and serviced to a good standard. We saw there is routine servicing of utilities such as electricity and gas which is carried out by external contractors. Specialist equipment such as lifts, and manual handling equipment is serviced in line with the manufacturer's recommendations.

Effective and efficient fire procedures, testing and training are in place to protect people. Records confirmed fire alarm tests take place regularly and an up-to-date fire risk assessment is in place. Every individual living at the home has a personal emergency evacuation plan specific to their support needs and staff undertake routine fire drills.

Hygiene and cleanliness standards are good. Staff follow a cleaning schedule to ensure the service remains clean and tidy. The kitchen has been awarded a score of five by the Food Standards Agency, which means 'very good' food hygiene standards. Laundry facilities are suitable for the size of the home and there is a plentiful supply of cleaning products which are stored in accordance with Control of Substances Hazardous to Health recommendations.

Security arrangements are in place to protect people. The home is secure to prevent unauthorised access. Visitors make themselves known on arrival and staff ensure they sign in and out of the premises.

Leadership & Management — Good

Care staff recruitment pre-employment checks are completed prior to employment commencing. This includes Disclosure and Barring Service and identity checks, along with references to confirm applicants are suitable to work with people. Care staff are registered with Social Care Wales (SCW), the work force regulator. New care staff receive an induction including shadowing more experienced staff and this was confirmed by care staff we spoke with. Care staff have the knowledge, competency and skills to provide the levels of care and support required to enable people to achieve their personal outcomes. The new manager has developed a new training matrix and is in the process of ensuring all staff complete the required training within the required timescales.

The service is well-led, with organisational arrangements, governance and oversight in place to help the service run smoothly. A new manager has been recruited since the last inspection; staff told us she is approachable and making positive changes within the home. A new suite of audits is being implemented. There are policies and procedures in place helping to underpin safe practice. We examined a selection of the service's policies including safeguarding, medication and infection control, which are reviewed and updated regularly. The manager understands legal requirements of caring for vulnerable people and liaises with the local authority safeguarding team when required. Applications are also made to the Deprivation of Liberty safeguards (DoLS) team and a new tracker for clearer oversight is in place. The RI regularly speaks to people and staff to help inform improvements. There are effective quality assurance measures in place. These include six-monthly quality of care reviews. The service has received numerous compliments about the quality of care staff provide. Management deal with complaints in line with the service's complaints policy.

The service has a strong vision and ethos. Its aims, values, and delivery of support are set out in the statement of purpose in a transparent way. A written guide is available for people in the service, containing practical information about the service, and the support provided. The service also offers a very good variety of formal and informal opportunities for people and their representatives, to ask questions and give feedback. The manager has an 'open door' approach and is very approachable, with staff telling us they feel valued and respected. They also told us: "*I enjoy my job, I love the residents*", "*The care is second to none*" and "*The new manager is lovely, really down to earth*".

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Welsh Government © Crown copyright 2025.
You may use and re-use the information featured in this publication (not including logos) free of charge in any format or medium, under the terms of the Open Government License. You can view the Open Government License, on the National Archives website or you can write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gov.uk
You must reproduce our material accurately and not use it in a misleading context.